

Supply Chain Innovation Observatory · Tracked Technologies · 2026 Q2

Every technology this Observatory watches, and the terms a document has to use to count as evidence for it. A term counts only where the document also uses supply chain language, so “computer vision” in a paper about faces is not a match.

AI transportation management

transportation management systems, TMS

Active cold chain packaging

active thermal packaging, active cold packaging, active packaging

Additive manufacturing for spare parts

additive manufacturing, 3d printed spare parts, 3d printed replacement parts

Advanced planning and scheduling

advanced planning and scheduling, advanced planning systems, APS

Agentic AI for procurement

agentic procurement, agentic sourcing, ai agents for procurement

Autonomous trucking

autonomous trucks, autonomous trucking, driverless trucks

Autonomous yard trucks

autonomous yard trucks, autonomous yard tractors...

Battery-free and energy-harvesting IoT

battery free, batteryless, energy harvesting

Blockchain traceability

blockchain traceability, blockchain provenance

Cold chain IoT monitoring

cold chain monitoring, cold chain visibility, cold chain sensors

Computer vision for logistics and inspection

automated damage inspection, automated defect inspection

Critical minerals traceability

critical minerals traceability, critical minerals supply chain, battery passport

Delivery drones

delivery drones, drone delivery, BVLOS

Digital freight matching

digital freight matching, digital freight brokerage, digital matching

Digital product passport

digital product passports

Domain-specific LLMs for supply chain

supply chain foundation LLMs, supply chain language models

ERP platforms

enterprise resource planning, ERP, S/4HANA

Electric heavy-duty trucks

electric semis, electric trucks, electric tractors

Freight EV charging infrastructure

truck charging corridors, truck charging depots, truck charging hubs

Freight decarbonization

green logistics

GS1 2D barcode transition

gs1 digital link, gs1 sunrise, 2d barcodes

General-purpose and humanoid robots in logistics

humanoid robots, general purpose humanoid, general purpose robots

Generative AI for supply chain planning

generative ai in supply chain, generative ai in procurement...

Hydrogen fuel cell trucks

hydrogen fuel cell trucks, hydrogen trucks, fuel cell electric trucks

Inland ports

inland ports, dry ports, inland container terminals

Item-level RFID

item level rfid, rfid tagging, RAIN RFID

Last-mile delivery optimization

last mile, quick commerce, same day delivery

Last-mile delivery robots

sidewalk delivery robots, sidewalk robots, last mile robots

ML demand forecasting

demand forecasting, demand sensing

Manufacturing execution systems

manufacturing execution systems, MES

Microfactories and distributed manufacturing

microfactory, microfactories, distributed manufacturing

Microfulfillment automation

micro fulfillment, dark stores, automated fulfillment center

Piece-picking robotics

piece picking, robotic item picking, robotic piece picking

Port and terminal automation

automated container terminals, automated terminals, port automation

Port electrification and shore power

shore power, cold ironing, port electrification

Positive train control

positive train control, PTC systems...

Private wireless and indoor positioning

private 5g networks, private 6g networks, private lte networks

Quantum optimization for logistics

quantum (annealing|optimi[sz]ation)[^.]{0,30}(logistics|routing|supply chain)

Rail intermodal technology

intermodal terminal, intermodal technology, intermodal automation

Robotic manufacturing cells

robotic manufacturing, robotic assembly, robotic welding

Sales and operations planning

sales and operations planning, S&OP, integrated business planning

Smart labels beyond RFID

smart labels, electronic shelf labels, printed electronics

Supply chain control towers

control towers

Supply chain digital twins

digital twins

Supply chain risk intelligence

risk intelligence platforms, risk monitoring platforms, risk intelligence

Vehicle routing and path optimization

vehicle routing, travelling salesman, pickup and delivery problem

Warehouse management systems

warehouse management systems, WMS

Warehouse robotics

warehouse robots, warehouse robotics, autonomous mobile robots